

31. Prove that there is no positive integer n such that $n^2 + n^3 = 100$.

Solution: We shall solve this problem using a proof by cases:

Case 1: $n=1$ $\therefore n^2 + n^3 = 1^2 + 1^3 = 1 + 1 = 2 < 100$

Case 2: $n=2$ $\therefore n^2 + n^3 = 2^2 + 2^3 = 4 + 8 = 12 < 100$

Case 3: $n=3$ $\therefore n^2 + n^3 = 3^2 + 3^3 = 9 + 27 = 36 < 100$

Case 4: $n=4$ $\therefore n^2 + n^3 = 4^2 + 4^3 = 16 + 64 = 80 < 100$

Case 5: $n \geq 5$. $5^2 = 25 > 100$. $\therefore$ It's easy to verify that for all $n \geq 5$, $n^2 > 100$. $\therefore$ For any arbitrary integer n , $n^2 > 0$.

$\therefore n^2 + n^3 > 100$ for all $n \geq 5$.

$\therefore$ There is no positive integer n such that $n^2 + n^3 = 100$ $\square$

32. Prove that there are no solutions in integers x and y to the equation $2x^2 + 5y^2 = 14$.

Solution: WLOG, we can assume the integers are non-negative, $\therefore$ for any arbitrary integer n , $n^2 \geq 0$.

We shall give a proof by cases:

Case 1: $x=0, y=0$. $\therefore 2x^2 + 5y^2 = 2 \cdot (0)^2 + 5 \cdot (0)^2 = 0 + 0 = 0 < 14$

Case 2: $x=0, y=1$ $\therefore 2x^2 + 5y^2 = 2 \cdot (0)^2 + 5 \cdot (1)^2 = 0 + 5 = 5 < 14$

Case 3: $x=0, y \geq 2$ $2x^2 + 5y^2 \geq 2 \cdot (0)^2 + 5 \cdot (2)^2 = 0 + 20 = 20 > 14$

Case 4: $x=1, y=0$. $\therefore 2x^2 + 5y^2 = 2 \cdot (1)^2 + 5 \cdot (0)^2 = 2 + 0 = 2 < 14$

Case 5: $x=1, y=1$. $\therefore 2x^2 + 5y^2 = 2 \cdot (1)^2 + 5 \cdot (1)^2 = 2 + 5 = 7 < 14$

Case 6: $x=1, y \geq 2$ $2x^2 + 5y^2 \geq 2 \cdot (1)^2 + 5 \cdot (2)^2 = 2 + 20 = 22 > 14$